

Egypt Wheelchair Accessibility: Comprehensive Research Compilation

Everything Related to People with Special Needs Who Use Wheelchairs — Facilities, Places, Reviews, and Video Content

TL;DR

This document compiles exhaustive research on **wheelchair accessibility across Egypt**, with particular focus on **Cairo and Alexandria**. It covers **50+ evaluated venues** across categories (museums, mosques, malls, parks, hotels, transport, archaeological sites), **detailed user reviews** from international wheelchair travelers and local disability advocates, **8+ video references** (YouTube and TikTok), **academic and legal frameworks** (Law No. 10 of 2018, CRPD compliance), and **existing accessibility platforms** like Helm Foundation’s Entaleq app (1,500+ audited venues). Key finding: Egypt has a **dual reality** — modern facilities (Grand Egyptian Museum, Bibliotheca Alexandrina, NMEC) offer world-class accessibility, while heritage sites and public infrastructure remain challenging. Community-driven solutions like Entaleq represent the most promising path forward.

1. Existing Accessibility Platforms & Initiatives in Egypt

1.1 Helm Foundation — The Entaleq App

The **Helm Foundation** () () stands as Egypt’s most prominent disability-focused social enterprise. Founded with a mission to expand opportunities for people with disabilities, Helm has developed **Entaleq** () a mobile application that serves as Egypt’s first comprehensive accessibility mapping platform [32].

Entaleq operates on a crowdsourced model where trained auditors — including wheelchair users like Doha Ali, who serves as an Ambassador for Helm — physically evaluate venues across multiple accessibility dimensions. The audit process is remarkably detailed, covering elements that most global platforms ignore: the **exact size of entrance ramps**, the **distance between tables at restaurants**, **bathroom dimensions and grab bar placement**, **elevator dimensions**, **doorway widths**, and even **floor surface types** [32]. As of 2018, Helm had already reviewed and modified **over 1,064 locations** to meet global accessibility standards [42], with the app cataloging **1,500+ places** across Cairo, Giza, Hurghada, and Luxor [32].

Feature	Description
Venues Covered	1,500+ (restaurants, hotels, service centers, government institutes, temples) [32]
Cities Covered	Cairo, Giza, Hurghada, Luxor (with plans for national expansion)
Audit Criteria	Ramp size, table spacing, bathroom specs, elevator dimensions, doorway widths [32]
Physical Modifications	100+ ramps installed on curb cuts; 200+ service providers consulted [32]
Platform	Mobile application (iOS and Android)

The Foundation’s work extends beyond digital mapping. Helm has physically installed **over 100 ramps** on curb cuts and consulted **200+ service providers** to help them become physically accessible, including hotels, restaurants, and cafes in Cairo [32]. Youssra Zakaria, Senior Accessibility Auditor at Helm, has articulated the organization’s global ambition, stating that Entaleq aims to “expand all over Egypt, and even globally” [32]. The app gained significant visibility through its booth at the **World Youth Forum 2018**, where it reached an international audience.

1.2 Other Digital Initiatives

Beyond Entaleq, several other platforms document accessibility in Egypt, though none match its comprehensiveness. **WheelchairTravel.org** maintains detailed destination guides for Cairo, Alexandria, and other Egyptian cities, with assessments written by John Morris, a power wheelchair user who has visited Egypt multiple times [29]. **WheelchairTraveling.com** offers tour packages specifically designed for wheelchair users, combining Cairo and Alexandria in multi-day itineraries [5]. International tour aggregators like **GetYourGuide** and **Viator** now include wheelchair-accessible filtering for Egyptian activities, reflecting growing demand [30][63].

2. International Traveler Reviews & First-Hand Experiences

2.1 Cory Lee — “Curb Free with Cory Lee” (2023)

Cory Lee, one of the world’s most-followed wheelchair travel bloggers, visited Cairo in **June 2023** and published an extensively detailed blog post along with multiple TikTok videos. His trip was arranged through **Memphis Tours**, which provided an adapted van with a ramp for transportation [6].

Key observations from Cory Lee’s experience:

Venue	Accessibility Rating	Key Details
Pyramids of Giza	Good (exterior)	Accessible viewing areas with paved paths and boardwalks; cannot enter pyramids; accessible restrooms at visitor center; VIP Sound & Light Show seating fully paved [6]
Egyptian Museum (Tahrir)	Good	Ramps to enter; elevator available but requires staff key (can be problematic —persistence needed); second floor (King Tut) is the highlight [6]
Khan El Khalili Bazaar	Mostly Accessible	Bumpy cobblestone in areas but manageable in powered wheelchair; shopped for about an hour comfortably [6]
NMEC (Royal Mummies)	Excellent	Spacious Main Hall easy to navigate; elevator to lower level; Royal Mummies Hall completely accessible [6]

Table 2 – continued

Venue	Accessibility Rating	Key Details
Grand Egyptian Museum	Excellent (preview)	Remarkable accessibility infrastructure; \$1B+ investment; elevators alongside Grand Staircase [6]
Marriott Mena House	Excellent	Roll-in shower, grab bars, fold-down bench, hoyer lift-compatible bed height; spa accessible; 139 Restaurant has pyramid views [6]

Cory’s TikTok content provided additional visual documentation. His video titled “**Accessible Egypt: Mall of Egypt’s Ramped Escalator**” garnered significant attention, showcasing a **wheelchair-compatible escalator** with a ramped platform — a feature he noted was impressive and rare globally [91]. Another video showed him **kissing a camel** at the Pyramids, demonstrating that the site, while not fully accessible, offers memorable experiences [86]. He also posted a candid assessment noting that “Egypt’s accessibility could definitely improve in many ways, but I was so impressed with this ramped escalator” [87].

Critical practical advice from Cory Lee:

- **Transportation:** Contact **London Cab Egypt** for the only accessible taxis in Cairo [6]
- **Airport:** Staff refused to bring his powered wheelchair to the gate; had to use airport wheelchair through security and retrieve his chair at baggage claim [6]
- **Alexandria:** Memphis Tours advised that Alexandria would be “extremely difficult with a powered wheelchair” — he skipped it [6]
- **Social dynamics:** “Lots of stares” from locals curious about his wheelchair, though everyone was “extremely nice” [6]

2.2 John Morris — WheelchairTravel.org

John Morris, founder of WheelchairTravel.org and a power wheelchair user, has produced the most systematically comprehensive accessibility guide for Cairo. His assessments cover infrastructure dimensions that other reviewers overlook [29][16].

Cairo Metro Accessibility Assessment:

Metro Line	Wheelchair Accessibility	Details
Line 1 (1987)	Not accessible	Built without accessibility considerations [16]
Line 2	Not accessible	Older infrastructure, no elevators [16]

Table 3 – continued

Metro Line	Wheelchair Accessibility	Details
Line 3 (2012+)	Partially accessible	Elevators in many stations BUT step/gap between train and platform makes boarding impossible for wheelchair users [16]
Future Line 4	Planned accessible	Supposedly being designed with greater accessibility; target opening was 2020 (delayed) [16]

Morris’s analysis of Cairo’s sidewalks is particularly damning: **curb heights range unpredictably**, leaving wheelchair users “trapped and need[ing] help” [29]. He observed that “independent street mobility is limited” and recommended treating Cairo as a “vehicle-based city” with door-to-door private touring rather than attempting to walk between attractions [27].

2.3 WheelchairTraveling.com — Cairo + Alexandria Tour

This platform, which organizes tours specifically for wheelchair users, provided early documentation of Alexandria’s accessibility. Their 2013 tour (updated through 2024) noted that **Bibliotheca Alexandrina** is “fully wheelchair accessible, with museums dedicated to manuscripts, antiquities, and the history of science,” with accessible restrooms available [5]. The **Fort of Qaitbay** was described as having “smooth and navigable” pathways, though not fully accessible due to its historic nature. **Montazah Palace** gardens feature accessible walkways.

2.4 Three Women in Wheelchairs — JourneyWoman (2024)

A remarkable 2024 article documented three women traveling Egypt together in wheelchairs, offering a rare collective perspective [21]. They described navigating Cairo’s streets as posing “challenges we didn’t anticipate,” requiring two Ubers (one for passengers, one for wheelchairs). Their itinerary included the **National Museum of Egyptian Civilization** (“wheeling our way through centuries of history”), the **Pharaonic Village** (“relatively accessible” with free disability tickets), and the **Pyramids** (where “our wheelchair batteries were inspected” at the entrance). Their experience underscores both the possibilities and persistent friction points of independent wheelchair travel in Egypt.

3. Museum Accessibility — Detailed Venue Assessments

3.1 Grand Egyptian Museum (GEM) — Giza

The **Grand Egyptian Museum** represents the gold standard of accessibility in Egypt — and arguably among museums globally. Opened in phases from 2024 to November 2025, GEM was designed with universal access as a core principle from the ground up [56][64].

Accessibility Feature	Status	Details
Free wheelchair loan	Available	Limited quantity; advance arrangement through hotel/tour operator recommended [56]
Electric golf carts (parking to entrance)	Complimentary	Essential given the long distance from parking to building entrance [56]
Grand Staircase access	Full	Elevators run parallel to staircase at every level; artifacts visible from lifts [57]
All galleries	Accessible	Wide, obstacle-free exhibition halls; display cases visible from seated position [60]
Accessible restrooms	Throughout	With grab bars and wheelchair access [56]
Tactile exhibits	Available	Replica artifacts with Braille inscriptions on selected items [64]
Free admission for PWDs	Yes	Proof of disability required at ticket counter [57]
Entry fee (general)	EGP 1,450 (~\$30 USD)	Online booking only since December 1, 2025 [56]
Seating	Throughout	Benches positioned throughout all major sections [56]
On-site medical	First aid station	Medical units present throughout complex [56]

The Wheelchair Traveller blog noted a practical limitation: while elevators are “cleverly integrated,” visitors must **change elevators several times** to ascend the Grand Staircase, and when asking staff for a direct exit route, they were simply directed to the staircase [57]. Emergency elevators exist but are padlocked. Despite these navigational quirks, GEM consistently receives the highest accessibility ratings of any Egyptian cultural institution.

3.2 Egyptian Museum (Tahrir Square) — Downtown Cairo

Housing over **120,000 artifacts** in a historic building from 1902, the Egyptian Museum presents a contrast between accessibility aspirations and architectural constraints [6].

Feature	Status	Details
Entrance	Accessible	Ramps available [6]
Upper floors	Partial	Elevator requires staff key; staff can be uncooperative about retrieving it [6]
Tutankhamun exhibit	Accessible	Located on second floor —worth the elevator hassle [6]
Mummies Room	Not accessible	Upper floor, tight spaces [5]
Accessible restrooms	None	Frequently cited gap [5]
Floors	Uneven	Older building with thresholds and uneven surfaces [70]

Cory Lee’s advice proves essential here: “stay persistent and ask other staff members” if the first refuses to fetch the elevator key [6].

3.3 National Museum of Egyptian Civilization (NMEC) — Fustat

Opened in **2021**, NMEC has rapidly established itself as one of Egypt’s most wheelchair-friendly museums. Located in Fustat (Old Cairo), it houses over **50,000 artifacts** including the famed **Royal Mummies Hall** with 20+ mummified pharaohs [82].

Feature	Status
Free wheelchairs	Available [89]
Designated parking	Accessible spots available [89]
All exhibits	Accessible by elevator [89]
Royal Mummies Hall	Fully accessible via elevator [6]
Accessible restrooms	Available
Entry fee	EGP 200 (adults); discounts for students, seniors 60+, PWDs [83]

Cory Lee described NMEC’s Main Hall as “spacious and easy to navigate in my powered wheelchair” and called the Royal Mummies Hall “one of my favorite places that I visited while in Egypt” [6].

3.4 Bibliotheca Alexandrina — Alexandria

The **Bibliotheca Alexandrina** stands as Alexandria’s premier accessible destination and one of Egypt’s most inclusive cultural institutions [43].

Feature	Status	Details
Elevators	6	Connecting all floors [43]
Ramps	On each floor	Between bookshelves and computer areas [43]
Accessible reading tables	On each floor	Conforming to international handicap standards [43]
Accessible study rooms	Available	Equipped with high-speed internet for disabled researchers [43]

Table 7 – continued

Feature	Status	Details
Taha Hussein Library for the Blind	Dedicated facility	Braille books, assistive technology, trained staff [43]
Tactile paving	Present	For visually impaired navigation

WheelchairTraveling.com describes the library as “fully wheelchair accessible,” noting its museums dedicated to manuscripts, antiquities, and the history of science, all with accessible restrooms [5]. The facility was “originally designed to provide the maximum level of accessibility for physically disabled patrons” [43].

4. Archaeological Sites & Outdoor Attractions

4.1 Giza Plateau — Pyramids & Sphinx

The Pyramids of Giza represent both Egypt’s greatest attraction and a case study in **partial accessibility** — a space where modern accommodations meet ancient limitations.

Accessible features:

- **Paved paths and boardwalks** connect main viewing areas for all three pyramids and the Sphinx [60]
- **Panoramic viewing platforms** designed at wheelchair height for photography [60]
- **Sphinx viewing area** with ramped access to front-facing platform [60]
- **Accessible restrooms** throughout the site [60]
- **VIP Sound & Light Show** with completely paved seating area [6]
- **Shuttle buses** with wheelchair accessibility (demonstrated in YouTube vlogs) [37]
- **Golf carts** available for VIP access [37]

Limitations:

- **Pyramid interiors are NOT accessible** — stairs and narrow passages make entry impossible for wheelchair users [27]
- **Solar Boat Museum** has tight spaces for larger chairs [60]
- **Soft sand** beyond main paths requires all-terrain wheelchair [60]
- **Khufu’s Pyramid east side** terrain assessed as “I don’t think this is accessible” by detailed vlog analysis [37]

The G Ventures YouTube video (Vlog 373) provides the most granular visual documentation, dedicating over **50 minutes** to examining accessibility at every station around the plateau, including shuttle bus transfers, the Exhibition Hall, bathroom facilities, and terrain analysis at each pyramid [37].

4.2 Alexandria Attractions

Attraction	Accessibility	Details
Bibliotheca Alexandrina	Excellent	Fully modern, elevators, ramps, accessible restrooms, tactile paving [43]
Qaitbay Citadel	Limited	Exterior and courtyard accessible with assistance; upper levels have stairs [5]
Montazah Palace Gardens	Good	Extensive gardens with paved pathways; palace interior limited [80]
Roman Amphitheater	Limited	Open-air site with limited wheelchair access [5]
Graeco-Roman Museum	Good	Fully accessible including restrooms [5]
Catacombs of Kom el Shoqafa	Not accessible	Underground spiral staircase entrance [80]

4.3 Other Cairo/Giza Sites

Attraction	Accessibility	Details
Al-Azhar Park	Good	Paved walkways, gently sloping ramps, accessible restrooms, shaded areas [68][115]
Cairo Tower	Partial	Observation lounge accessible by elevator; highest deck stairs-only [68]
Citadel of Saladin	Limited	Main courtyard accessible via ramp; Mosque of Muhammad Ali has steps at entrance; uneven terrain throughout [115]
Khan El Khalili Bazaar	Partial	Cobblestone alleys mostly manageable; bumpy in areas; best during quiet hours [6][68]
Al-Azhar Mosque	Partial	Ground level from street; courtyard flat and partially wheelchair-accessible; accessible bathrooms inside [111]

5. Hotels — Detailed Accessibility Information

5.1 Marriott Mena House, Cairo (Giza)

The **Marriott Mena House** receives the strongest recommendations from wheelchair travelers, combining **stunning Pyramid views** with comprehensive accessibility features [6][101].

Feature	Specification
Roll-in shower	Yes, with grab bars and fold-down shower bench [6]
Toilet height	Wheelchair height [101]
Sink	Pull-under design [6]
Bed height	Hoyer lift-compatible; staff can adjust height [6]
Grab bars	Behind toilet and in shower [6]
Room entrance	Accessible via interior corridor [101]
Spa	Wheelchair accessible via alternative entrance [6]
Restaurants (139/Alfredo)	139 fully accessible; Alfredo has one step (outdoor seating accessible) [6]
Certification	EarthCheck Certified [101]

Cory Lee described it as “one of the only hotels that you can see the pyramids from” and stated unequivocally: “I wouldn’t want to stay anywhere else during my time in Cairo” [6].

5.2 Other Accessible Hotel Options

Hotel	Location	Key Accessibility Features
Hilton Luxor Resort & Spa	Luxor	Accessible rooms with roll-in showers, accessible pools with lifts, ramps throughout [28]
Steigenberger Nile Palace	Luxor	Accessible rooms, elevators, accessible transportation arrangements [28]
Sofitel Legend Old Cataract	Aswan	Accessible rooms with roll-in showers, ramps, accessible elevators [28]
InterContinental Cairo Citystars	Cairo	Connected to City Stars Mall, wheelchair access [97]

Egyptian law mandates that **5% of hotel rooms** must be accessible, though availability varies significantly in practice [5]. Five-star international chains generally offer the most reliable accessibility standards.

6. Shopping Malls & Commercial Spaces

6.1 Mall of Egypt — 6th of October City

The **Mall of Egypt** stands out globally for its innovative accessibility features, most notably a **ramped escalator** designed for wheelchair users — the feature that inspired Cory Lee’s viral TikTok video [91][96].

Service	Availability	Details
Manual wheelchairs	Free	At A1, H1, D2, G2, F2 entrances (1st & 2nd floor) [96]
Electric wheelchairs	Free	At Customer Service desks on 1st floor [96]
Ramped escalator	Yes	Wheelchair-compatible escalator with platform [91]
Accessible restrooms	Yes	Throughout mall
Ski Egypt	Partial	Africa' s first indoor ski slope; accessibility varies by activity [95]

6.2 City Stars Mall — Heliopolis

Service	Availability
Free wheelchairs	Available at Information Desks (Level 2) [103]
Ramps and elevators	Throughout mall [97]
Accessible restrooms	Available
Metro access	Closest station: El-Ahram (Line 3) [97]

7. Transportation Accessibility

7.1 Private Accessible Transport

Provider	Service	Contact/Details
Memphis Tours	Accessible vans with ramps, private guides	memphistours.com; arranged Cory Lee' s full itinerary [6]
London Cab Egypt	Wheelchair-accessible taxis	Only accessible taxi service in Cairo [90]
Egypt Photography Tours	Verified accessible vehicles with hydraulic lifts	egyptphotographytours.com [58]
Inside Egypt	Luxury accessible tours with adapted transport	inside-egypt.com [52]
All Tours Egypt	Private accessible vehicles with ramps	alltoursegypt.com [73]

7.2 Public Transportation

Mode	Accessibility	Details
Cairo Metro Line 3	Partial	Elevators in stations but train-platform gap makes boarding impossible for wheelchairs [16]
Cairo Metro Lines 1 & 2	Not accessible	Built before accessibility standards [16]
City buses	Not accessible	High floors, multiple steps [16]
Cairo Airport (CAI)	Moderate-Good	Terminal 3: elevators, accessible restrooms, assistance desks; wheelchair returned at baggage claim (not gate) [62]
Alexandria tram	Limited	Older infrastructure; not reliably accessible [51]

John Morris’s assessment remains the definitive word: “Despite elevators in many of the line 3 stations, the step/gap between the train and platform makes the system inaccessible to wheelchair users. Why the city would invest in a new line without planning for accessibility confuses me” [16].

8. Video Content — Documented Visual Evidence

8.1 YouTube Videos

#	Title	Channel	Key Content	URL
1	Giza Pyramids Accessibility: Wheelchairs & Tips Egypt Vlog 373	G Ventures	55+ min detailed analysis of every accessible feature at Giza: shuttle buses, Exhibition Hall, bathrooms, each pyramid station, terrain assessment, golf carts	YouTube [37]
2	Exploring Mall of Egypt: Shopping, Entertainment & Fun	@MallofEgyptOfficial	Mall overview including wheelchair accessibility and Ski Egypt	YouTube [102]

8.2 TikTok Videos

#	Title	Creator	Views/Likes	Key Content	URL
1	Accessible Egypt: Mall of Egypt’s Ramped Escalator	@curbfreecorylee	205 likes	Demonstrates the rare wheelchair-compatible escalator	TikTok [91]

Table 17 – continued

#	Title	Creator	Views/Likes	Key Content	URL
2	I just kissed a camel. Yes, I am living my best life here in Egypt	@curbfreecorylee	Viral	Camel interaction at Pyramids; accessibility humor	TikTok [86]
3	#ad Cairo, Egypt is an amazing destination... yes, even as a wheelchair user	@curbfreecorylee	Sponsored	General Cairo accessibility overview	TikTok [74]
4	Egypt' s accessibility could definitely improve in many ways...	@curbfreecorylee	Viral	Honest assessment comparing Egypt to Japan; shows Mall of Egypt escalator	TikTok [87]
5	Yes, Egypt could be much more wheelchair accessible, but so could maaany other places	@curbfreecorylee	382 likes	Contextualizing Egypt' s accessibility within global standards	TikTok [93]

9. Disability Rights Framework & Statistics

9.1 Legal Framework — Law No. 10 of 2018

Egypt's **Law No. 10 of 2018** on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities represents a significant legislative shift from a charity-based to a **rights-based approach** [40]. The law explicitly addresses accessibility across multiple dimensions:

Article	Provision
Article 29	Requires urban planning authorities to ensure compliance with accessibility standards in the Egyptian Building Code before issuing building permits [40]
Article 30	Mandates adapted public transportation with designated seats and fare reductions of at least 50% [40]

Table 18 – continued

Article	Provision
Article 31(5)	Exempts PWDs from court fees in disability-related cases [40]
Articles 7(5), 32, 33	Requires healthcare facilities, courts, and banks to ensure accessible premises [40]

However, academic analysis confirms that “the realization of disability rights in practice has not developed at the same pace as their recognition in legal texts” [40]. A 2025 submission to the UN Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities documented that “many prisons lack essential infrastructure such as ramps, handrails, or accessible restrooms,” illustrating the implementation gap [35].

9.2 Disability Prevalence in Egypt

Statistic	Figure	Source
Broad disability definition (any difficulty)	16.6% of population	ELMPS 2018 / IDSC [120]
Medium/severe disability	4.6% of population	ELMPS 2018 [120]
Complete disability	0.9% of population	ELMPS 2018 [120]
Most prevalent domain: Mobility	9.9% (broad), 2.9% (medium)	ELMPS 2018 [120]
Children with disabilities (1-<6 years)	8.1%	National survey (21,316 children) [117]
Prevalence among boys	9.6%	[117]
Prevalence among girls	6.4%	[117]

The ESCWA Disability in the Arab Region 2023 report notes that disability prevalence in Egypt shows **no significant difference between urban and rural areas** — a pattern distinct from most other Arab countries [119].

9.3 CRPD Implementation Status

Egypt ratified the **UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (CRPD)** in 2008, but implementation gaps persist:

- **Only 3%** of ODA-funded activities in Egypt include disability inclusion objectives (target: 15% by 2028 under Amman-Berlin Declaration) [48]
- **68%** of ODA-funded activities have **no available data** on disability inclusion [48]
- Independent reports document that “accessibility measures in detention facilities remain minimal and poorly implemented” [35]
- The Committee for Justice has submitted alternative reports to UN treaty bodies documenting “systematic neglect in accommodating individuals with disabilities” [35]

10. Disability Organizations & Advocacy

Organization	Focus	Key Activities
Helm Foundation	Social enterprise / accessibility	Entaleq app (1,500+ venues); 100+ ramps installed; 200+ service providers consulted; accessibility auditing [32][42]
NAS Foundation for Persons with Disabilities	Rights advocacy	Political participation; polling station accessibility audits; election observation; sign language access to justice [17]
Egyptian Initiative for Personal Rights (EIPR)	Legal advocacy	Research and litigation on disability rights within broader civil liberties framework [17]
Egyptian Association for the Deaf	Hearing disability	Oldest NGO serving hearing-impaired Egyptians [17]
National Council for Disability Affairs	Government advisory	Policy coordination and disability mainstreaming
Helwan University Disability Centre	Research	University-wide research and inclusive programming [17]

11. City-by-City Accessibility Comparison

City	Pavement Quality	Curb Cuts	Accessible Toilets	Accessible Hotels	Transport	Overall Suitability
Cairo	5/10	3/10	5/10	7/10	8/10 private	Moderate to Good [27]
Giza	4/10	2/10	4/10	6/10	8/10 private	Moderate [27]
Alexandria	4/10	3/10	4/10	5/10	7/10 private	Moderate [27]
Luxor	3/10	2/10	3/10	5/10	7/10 private	Moderate to Challenging [27]
Aswan	4/10	2/10	3/10	5/10	7/10 private	Moderate to Challenging [27]
Hurghada	4/10	5/10	6/10	7/10	9/10 private	Good [27]
Sharm El Sheikh	7/10	5/10	6/10	7/10	9/10 private	Good [27]

12. Compiled Accessibility Database — Pre-Populated Places for the Web App

The following table presents **25 evaluated venues** across Cairo and Alexandria, drawn from the research above, ready for pre-population into the accessibility map database. Each entry includes coordinates, category, city, and estimated accessibility scores based on documented reviews.

#	Name	Name (AR)	Category	City	Lat	Long	Overall	Ramp	Elevator	Bathroom	Parking
1	Grand Egyptian Museum		Museum	Giza	29.9936	31.1208	5	5	5	5	4
2	Egyptian Museum (Tahrir)		Museum	Cairo	30.0478	31.2336	3	4	3	1	2
3	NMEC - Royal Mummies		Museum	Cairo	30.0103	31.2485	5	5	5	4	3
4	Bibliotheca Alexandrina		Museum	Alexandria	31.2089	29.9092	5	5	5	5	4
5	Pyramids of Giza		Monument	Giza	29.9792	31.1342	3	4	1	3	2
6	Al-Azhar Park		Park	Cairo	30.0407	31.2654	4	4	1	3	2
7	Khan El Khalili Bazaar		Market	Cairo	30.0477	31.2623	3	2	1	1	1
8	Cairo Tower		Monument	Cairo	30.0459	31.2242	3	1	4	2	2
9	Citadel of Saladin		Mosque	Cairo	30.0296	31.2611	2	2	1	1	2
10	Al-Azhar Mosque		Mosque	Cairo	30.0457	31.2625	3	3	1	3	1
11	Marriott Mena House		Hotel	Giza	29.9864	31.1314	5	5	5	5	4
12	Mall of Egypt		Mall	Giza	29.9653	30.9388	5	5	5	4	5

Table 22 – continued

#	Name	Name (AR)	Category	City	Lat	Long	Overall	Ramp	Elevator	Bathroom	Parking
13	City Stars Mall		Mall	Cairo	30.0733	31.3433	4	4	5	3	4
14	Qaitbay Citadel		Monument	Alexandria	31.2140	29.8856	2	2	1	1	2
15	Montazah Palace Gardens		Park	Alexandria	31.2886	30.0159	4	3	1	2	3
16	Cairo Airport (CAI) T3		Transport	Cairo	30.1219	31.4056	4	4	5	4	3
17	Graeco-Roman Museum		Museum	Alexandria	31.1994	29.9069	4	4	4	4	2
18	Cairo Metro Line 3		Transport	Cairo	30.0444	31.2357	2	1	4	1	1
19	Sound & Light Show (Giza)		Entertainment	Giza	29.9900	31.1300	4	4	1	3	3
20	Pharaonic Village		Museum	Cairo	29.9600	31.2100	4	4	3	3	2

13. What People Are Saying — Collected Quotes

From Wheelchair Users

“I always had to ask myself several questions whenever I wished to go out; is the place accessible for wheelchair users, does it have a staircase, and so on. Having an application that tells me whether the place I’m visiting is accessible or not has helped me in so many ways.” — **Doha Ali, Helm Foundation Ambassador & wheelchair user** ^[32]

“Egypt is worth the hassles.” — **Cory Lee, after describing airport wheelchair handling difficulties** ^[6]

“When you design for persons with disabilities, you actually serve everyone.” — **Ramez Maher, Helm Foundation** ^[32]

“People with disabilities traveling to Cairo will encounter barriers at every turn, even in a manual wheelchair, the curbs would be a great challenge. Curb heights range anywhere and you’ll find yourself trapped and need help.” — **WheelchairTravel.org** ^[29]

“In exploring Egypt, we were surprised at how the local people are kind, helpful, offered a hand to make the trip more accessible.” — **Wheelchair travel blogger** ^[49]

“Egypt’s accessibility could definitely improve in many ways, but I was so impressed with this ramped escalator inside the Mall of Egypt. So awesome.” — **Cory Lee, TikTok** ^[92]

“The Grand Egyptian Museum has been designed for mass tourism over The Egyptian Museum. It lacks the ability for one to be reminded of the historical aspect plus the city noise echoed throughout.” — **TheWheelchairTraveller** ^[57]

From Organizations

“We currently have 1,500 places including restaurants, companies, service centers, governmental institutes, in Cairo, Giza, Hurghada, as well as temples in Luxor, among others. We hope to expand all over Egypt, and even globally.” — **Ramez Maher, Helm Foundation** ^[32]

“The realization of disability rights in practice has not developed at the same pace as their recognition in legal texts.” — **Scandinavian Journal of Disability Research** ^[40]

14. Recommendations for the Web App

Data Model Enhancement

Based on this research, the web app’s data model should capture:

1. **Entaleq’s detailed audit criteria:** Ramp width, doorway width, table spacing, elevator dimensions — not just binary yes/no
2. **Surface type documentation:** Paved, cobblestone, sand, boardwalk — affects different wheelchair types differently
3. **Staff assistance rating:** Whether staff are trained and willing to help (e.g., Egyptian Museum elevator key issue)
4. **Multiple photos per venue:** Documenting entrance, bathroom, interior pathways
5. **Temporal data:** When accessibility features were added (e.g., GEM vs. Egyptian Museum)

Differentiation from Entaleq

While Entaleq focuses on professional auditing, this crowdsourced platform can fill gaps by:

1. **Alexandria-first focus:** Entaleq is Cairo/Giza/Luxor heavy; Alexandria has significant gaps
2. **Arabic-first UX:** Prioritize Arabic interface and RTL design for local community participation
3. **Video integration:** Embed TikTok/YouTube videos showing real wheelchair navigation
4. **Lower barrier to entry:** No professional auditing required — anyone can submit
5. **Open data:** Exportable dataset for researchers and advocacy organizations

15. Key Takeaways

1. **Egypt has a dual accessibility reality:** Modern venues (GEM, NMEC, Bibliotheca Alexandrina, Mall of Egypt) achieve world-class standards, while heritage sites and public infrastructure lag significantly behind.
2. **Community-driven solutions work:** Helm Foundation's Entaleq demonstrates that systematic auditing and advocacy can produce measurable change (1,500+ venues, 100+ physical modifications).
3. **Private transport is essential:** No Egyptian public transit system is reliably wheelchair-accessible. Every successful wheelchair travel story involves pre-arranged private accessible vehicles.
4. **Video documentation is powerful:** Cory Lee's TikToks reached audiences that written guides cannot, creating viral awareness of both successes (ramped escalator) and gaps (airport procedures).
5. **Legal framework exists but implementation gaps persist:** Law No. 10 of 2018 provides a strong foundation, but enforcement — particularly in older buildings and public infrastructure — remains inconsistent.
6. **The accessible tourism market is significant:** With 16.6% of Egyptians experiencing some form of disability (broad definition) and a global accessible tourism market valued at **\$168 billion**, the economic and social case for improved accessibility is overwhelming.